

Daily Bible Note

Date: September 9, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Psalm 119:121-136

121 I have done justice and righteousness; do not leave me to my oppressors.

122 Be surety for Your servant for good; do not let the proud oppress me.

123 My eyes fail from seeking Your salvation and Your righteous word.

124 Deal with Your servant according to Your mercy, and teach me Your statutes.

125 I am Your servant; give me understanding, that I may know Your testimonies.

126 It is time for You to act, O LORD, for they have regarded Your law as void.

127 Therefore I love Your commandments more than gold, yes, than fine gold!

128 Therefore all Your precepts concerning all things I consider to be right; I hate every false way.

129 Your testimonies are wonderful; therefore my soul keeps them.

130 The entrance of Your words gives light; it gives understanding to the simple.

131 I opened my mouth and panted, for I longed for Your commandments.

132 Look upon me and be merciful to me, as Your custom is toward those who love Your name.

133 Direct my steps by Your word, and let no iniquity have dominion over me.

134 Redeem me from the oppression of man, that I may keep Your precepts.

135 Make Your face shine upon Your servant, and teach me Your statutes.

136 Rivers of water run down from my eyes, because men do not keep Your law.

II. Key Summary

- The psalmist asks God to be surety for him and not to let the proud oppress him; in this passage he calls himself God's "servant" four times (vv. 122, 124, 125, 135).
 - He says, "It is time for You to act, O LORD, for they have regarded Your law as void," and then says he loves God's commandments more than gold, more than fine gold, and hates every false way (vv. 126-128).
 - He asks God to direct his steps by His word and to let no iniquity have dominion over him; he ends by saying rivers of water run down from his eyes, because men do not keep God's law (vv. 133, 136).
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III. Passage Analysis

When the Word comes in, light comes in

"As soon as the word of God enters into us, and has a place in us, it enlightens us; we find we begin to see when we begin to study the word of God. It would give understanding even to the simple, to the weakest capacities." [1]

Verse 130 says, "The entrance of Your words gives light; it gives understanding to the simple." Seeing clearly doesn't run on how smart you are — the word itself is what gives off light. So when you don't get it, the move is to keep letting it in, not to fix yourself up first.

Steady steps are something you ask for

"But let us mark, how fully is this prayer warranted by the special promise of the Gospel — 'Sin shall not have dominion over you; for ye are not under the law, but under grace' (Romans 6:14)." [2]

In verse 133 the psalmist doesn't say "I will stand firm." He says, "Direct my steps by Your word, and let no iniquity have dominion over me." Sin losing its grip is something he asks God for, and something God has promised to give.

IV. Reflection Question

Has there been a moment when a word from the Bible shone light on you or moved you?
How did that passage help you?

The word translated "entrance" in verse 130 literally means "opening" — as when Jesus explained the Scriptures to the disciples on the road to Emmaus and their hearts burned within them (Luke 24:32). The word has to be opened before the light and the warmth can come in. [3]

References

[1] Blue Letter Bible, Matthew Henry Complete Commentary (Psalm 119),
https://www.blueletterbible.org/comm/mhc/Psa/Psa_119.cfm

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik, Commentary on Psalm 119 (citing Charles Bridges),
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/psalm-119/>

[3] Chinese Christian Bible Study Website, Tyndale Old Testament Commentary on Psalm 119, <https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/19Psa/19GT119.htm>